

The lock screen shows the current date and time, and can be configured to show a lot more. You can have it show information from as many as eight different apps, of which one can show detailed information. The lock screen background can also be changed, which we will come to later.

The lock screen is a good place to get an overview of your system, and can tell you at a glance whether you need to interact with your system to check mail, return an IM etc.

There's nothing much to do with it but dispel it and get on with your work, which fortunately is as simple as clicking anywhere, pressing any key or sliding the lock screen away. This reveals the login screen.

Modern UI settings

A result of the dichotomy between Modern UI and traditional / classic desktop UI in Windows 8, there also two control panels of sorts.



Here the lockscreen is showing details for the calendar app and icons for a couple of apps such as mail

The traditional Control Panel is retained, but there is a new touch-friendly settings application that can configure common Metro UI settings.

To access this panel all you need to do is use the **Settings charm** and click on the bottommost “Change PC settings” link.

This area can be used to configure most new UI aspects of Windows 8, such as the Lock screen, stat screen, notifications, search, sharing, syncing and a lot more. We'll go by each setting in turn.

Personalise: Here you can configure the visual aspects of the Modern UI.

You can set a Lock screen wallpaper, and configure which applications should show information on the lock screen. For the start screen you have a range of designs and patterns available that can be applied – in addition to no style – and you can pick from a number of pre-defined colour schemes. You can also pick an account picture which will then be shown on the start screen and login screen.

Users: Windows is a multi-user OS, and that hasn't gone with Windows 8 even as devices become increasingly personal. Here you can add